July 23, 2025
Newsletter

Hidden Signs of Dehydration in Seniors You Shouldn’t Ignore

...Not Even A Slight Headache



Dehydration happens when your body loses more fluids than it takes in.

As you get older, your sense of thirst is blunted, so you may not recognize your body’s need for fluids. Know the signals you may have waited a bit too long to drink up, and why it matters

Water is life. When there’s too little fluid in the body, it can affect many organ systems, because about 60% of the human body is made up of water.

In this email, you'll learn the **lesser-known signs of dehydration** and **the best way to stay hydrated**

(Bonus hydration tips at the end!)

1. Thirst (or Lack of It)

As people age, their sense of thirst becomes less reliable, which means many older adults may not feel thirsty even when their bodies need water.

Even if you don't feel thirsty, older adults should drink throughout the day. Aim for at least 48 ounces of fluid (six 8-ounce glasses) daily, and more if you're physically active.

You can also boost your intake with water-rich foods like soups, watermelon, and cucumber.

2. Muscle Cramps or Weakness

Maintaining muscle strength and balance is already a challenge as we age, and dehydration only makes it worse.

Fluids carry essential minerals like potassium, sodium, and magnesium. When hydration drops, so do these electrolytes, disrupting muscle function and causing painful cramps.

Dehydration also reduces blood volume, which means less oxygen and fewer nutrients reach the muscles.

This can lead to an increase in fall risk, reduced dependency, and fatigue and dependency

3. Dry Skin or Poor Skin Elasticity

While it may seem like a minor issue, dry skin or reduced skin elasticity can actually be an early warning sign of internal dehydration.

As we age, skin naturally becomes thinner and less elastic. Dehydration accelerates this, making the skin more fragile and prone to tears or bruising.

Quick Skin Test: Gently pinch the skin on the back of your hand. If it returns slowly or stays pinched, it may indicate dehydration.

Prevention Tip:

- Use moisturizing lotion after bathing
- Avoid hot showers and drying soaps

4. Confusion

This is one of the most serious — and often overlooked — signs of dehydration. Confusion, disorientation, or sudden memory lapses are frequently mistaken for

dementia or cognitive decline, but they can often be caused by insufficient fluid intake.

The brain is highly sensitive to changes in fluid balance. Dehydration can reduce blood flow and oxygen to the brain, affecting cognitive function.

Older adults with existing conditions like dementia or stroke are especially vulnerable. If not addressed quickly, confusion due to dehydration can escalate into hospitalization or even become life-threatening.



Join Us Next Month!

Attend our free Memory Café held on the 2nd Wednesday of every month at Brightview in Catonsville. Lunch will be provided. Call or email us for further registration details!

When: Second Wednesday of each month

Time: 12:00 PM - 1:00 PM

Venue: Brightview Rolling Hills, 848 South Rolling Road, Catonsville.

Register: Call anytime at (240)-423-3099 to register and receive updates

We're Here to Help

At Spirit of Hope Home Care, we're here to support you every step of the way. Whether you're seeking guidance, care options, or simply someone to talk to, please know you're not alone.

Call us at (240) 423-3099

Email: care@spiritofhopeagency.com

Let us help you or a loved one live with dignity, comfort, and confidence.

With warm regards,